



Strategic Plan

2021 - 2026



Statement from the Board

This Strategic Plan 2021-2026 reflects our vision for improving the health, wellbeing and prosperity of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people on Palm Island.

This is an important time in the history of the Palm Island Community Company (PICC), as we move from a Company with Shareholders, to a Community Controlled Model. While PICC has always operated along community control principles, the new governance model demonstrates PICC's commitment to self-determination and greater community involvement in decision-making processes.

While the new Company looks forward to doing things differently – engaging the community to a greater extent – we will also carry forward those things that have made us strong. We would like to acknowledge the efforts of management and staff in bringing us to where we are now. The PICC workforce has remained very stable over our 12 years of operation, and this stable, committed workforce has been the driving force for the achievements to date. They will be critical to the work ahead.

One of the initial key tasks of the new company is consolidating our role as an Aboriginal and Islander

Community Controlled Health Organisation (AICCHO). Building on the foundation laid by our primary health services, and the aspirations of the Palm Island Community – as articulated in the Palm Island Health Action Plan 2018-2028 – the new AICCHO represents a key step in realising the vision of a healthy Palm Island. As an AICCHO, PICC is committed to providing culturally appropriate health care that encompasses physical, social, emotional, cultural, spiritual and economic wellbeing.

The intent of this Plan is to clearly inform our community and other stakeholders of our planned priorities.

This Strategic Plan sets out the Vision, Mission, Purpose, Values, Strategic Priorities, Goals and Planned Outcomes that will guide the operational priorities of our PICC workforce, to support them as they work to improve the health, wellbeing and prosperity of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people on Palm Island. As this Plan has been developed during the COVID-19 Pandemic, it has been important to reflect on the need to be adaptive and responsive, and adjust to new challenges as they arise. While our specific goals and planned outcomes may change, the overarching vision, mission, purpose, values, and priorities remain the same, and guide our responses.

The intent of this Plan is to clearly inform our community and other stakeholders of our planned priorities, provide a reporting framework to keep our community and other stakeholders advised of

progress, and provide our management and staff with a clear direction to respond to current and emerging health, community and

economic needs on Palm Island. This plan positions PICC to respond strategically to, and take advantage of, the current and future opportunities that are presented by government reforms in health, child protection, early childhood services and justice, so that we can close the gap of disparity across these areas, in partnership with our community and other stakeholders.

Responding to Current & Future Opportunities in Partnership with our Community and Other Stakeholders

In developing this Strategic Plan 2021-2026, PICC has considered the priorities of Commonwealth and State Governments in the delivery of health and community services to Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people. PICC will align its operational priorities with those of the Joint Council on Closing the Gap.

While PICC supports the pledge of the Council of Australian Governments (COAG) to 'Close the Gap' in disadvantage and health outcomes between Indigenous and non-Indigenous Australians, we also recognise that there was insufficient focus on the role of the community controlled sector in addressing this gap.

While applauding the successes outlined in the 2020 Closing the Gap Report, we also recognise that the failures point to a lack of genuine partnership with the community controlled sector, and highlight the need to do things differently. We recognise that it is the community controlled sector that must lead these efforts. We therefore applaud the commitment made by COAG, in December 2018, to forming a genuine formal partnership with Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples to finalise the Closing the Gap Refresh and provide a forum for ongoing engagement throughout implementation of the new agenda.

PICC supports the formal Partnership Agreement between COAG and the National Coalition of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peak Organisations. We support the creation of the new Joint Council on Closing the Gap, and the four "Priority Reforms" outlined in National Agreement on Closing the Gap, to change the way governments work with Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities, organisations and people across the country to accelerate improvements in Closing the Gap:

1. Ensuring Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander own governance and decision-making structures are supported.
2. Recognising community-controlled organisations are an act of self-determination where Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people deliver services to their communities based on our own needs, cultures and relationship to land.
3. Confronting institutionalised racism in government mainstream institutions and agencies to ensure Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people can access the services they need in a culturally safe way.
4. Sharing data and information with Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people to ensure Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people have more power to determine their own development.

As PICC establishes itself as a community controlled health service – part of a broader sector that will be strengthened under the second Priority Reform – we recognise our role in delivering Closing the Gap services and programs.

In particular, PICC has a pivotal role to play, on Palm Island, in relation to 12 of the 16 targeted outcomes for the Closing the Gap Refresh – as outlined in the table below – and this Plan therefore aligns with the national agenda. As a key 'connector' between the community and other services on Palm Island, PICC also contributes indirectly to the remaining four outcomes, which relate to: Education (outcome 5); Housing (outcome 9); Land and water (outcome 15); and Culture and Language (outcome 16).

Table 1: CTG outcomes and targets directly measured by PICC programs and services

#	Outcome	Target
1	Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people enjoy long and healthy lives	Close the Gap in life expectancy within a generation, by 2031.
2	Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander children are born healthy and strong	By 2031, increase the proportion of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander babies with a healthy birthweight to 91 per cent.
3	Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander children are engaged in high quality, culturally appropriate early childhood education in their early years	By 2025, increase the proportion of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander children enrolled in Year Before Fulltime Schooling (YBFS) early childhood education to 95 per cent.
4	Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander children thrive in their early years	By 2031, increase the proportion of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander children assessed as developmentally on track in all five domains of the Australian Early Development Census (AEDC) to 55 per cent.
6	Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander students reach their full potential through further education pathways	By 2031, increase the proportion of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people aged 25-34 years who have completed a tertiary qualification (Certificate III and above) to 70 per cent.
7	Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander youth are engaged in employment or education	By 2031, increase the proportion of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander youth (15-24 years) who are in employment, education or training to 67 per cent.
8	Strong economic participation and development of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people and communities	By 2031, increase the proportion of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people aged 25-64 who are employed to 62 per cent.
10	Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people are not overrepresented in the criminal justice system	By 2031, reduce the rate of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander adults held in incarceration by at least 15 per cent.
11	Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander young people are not overrepresented in the criminal justice system	By 2031, reduce the rate of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander young people (10-17 years) in detention by at least 30 per cent.
12	Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander children are not overrepresented in the child protection system	By 2031, reduce the rate of over-representation of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander children in out-of-home care by 45 per cent.
13	Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander families and households are safe	A significant and sustained reduction in violence and abuse against Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander women and children towards zero.
14	Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people enjoy high levels of social and emotional wellbeing	Significant and sustained reduction in suicide of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people towards zero.

We recognise that partnerships – with our community, our peaks, our funding bodies, and service partners – are critical in achieving the required outcomes of our Strategic Priorities. This plan aligns to key priorities for our key partners, including:

- Queensland Government and Palm Island Aboriginal Shire Council's *Palm Island Health Action Plan 2018-2028*
- Queensland Health's *Making Tracks toward closing the gap in health outcomes for Indigenous*

Queenslanders by 2033: Policy and Accountability Framework

- Family Matters and Queensland Government's *Our Way A generational strategy for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander children and families 2017-2037*

We will also continue to work closely with the Palm Island Aboriginal Shire Council, and the Palm Island Elders Reference Group to ensure that that we continue to focus on the priorities of the Palm Island community.

Vision

A healthy, resilient, and productive Palm Island.

Mission

Quality integrated and responsive services that meet community needs and are delivered by Palm Islanders.

Purpose

To promote and advance the empowerment, health, well-being and sustainability of the Manbarra and Bwgcolman peoples.

Values

Responsiveness:

- Providing timely responses to people and their needs
- Adapting to the changing needs of community, service users, funding bodies and service partners.

Empowerment and Empathy:

- Committed to self-determination
- Welcoming to all Palm Islanders

Leadership and Responsibility:

- Providing strong, consistent and accountable governance and management
- Providing a clear vision of the future
- Fostering Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander leadership across the organisation
- Underpinning everything with do with risk-based thinking

Integrity and Productivity:

- Building a workforce that is skilled, experienced, and connected to community
- Providing quality services and value for money
- Acting transparently and being a “truth-teller”
- Doing what we promise

Community Engagement and Participation:

- Keeping the community informed
- Enhancing opportunities for community involvement in decision-making process
- Seeking feedback and community input
- Putting the community’s wellbeing at the centre of everything we do

Transparency and Accountability:

- Meeting financial, management and quality Standards
- Being accountable to the people of Palm Island, and all other stakeholders

Connection:

- Connecting government to community for the delivery of services
- Connecting people with each other through programs
- Connecting client referrals for integrated holistic support
- Connecting a network of service providers and specialists

Strategic Priorities

What We'll Do and How We'll Measure Progress

Strategic Priority 1:

To provide strong and effective governance that supports service delivery and growth, promotes the social and economic advancement of Palm Island and its people, and is characterised by community engagement, sustainability, transparency and accountability.

Goals	Outcomes
Develop and implement a Communications and Engagement Strategy for community and other stakeholders	Improvements in internal and external communications, and to perceptions of PICC
Monitor, assess and report Progress against Strategic Plan	PICC achievements are measured and communicated, internally and externally, enhancing perceptions of PICC
Develop and implement evaluation and monitoring systems that support monitored learning throughout the organisation.	- PICC has an evaluation system in place that: - Measures impact of services and programs via a community dashboard of qualitative and quantitative data, using Indigenous knowledge and Indigenous data sovereignty principles - Includes indicators for success that are values- and strengths-based to support operational learning - PICC contributes to research and forums that inform the development of knowledge and policy that improves health and wellbeing outcomes for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people.
Develop policies and procedures that support the creation of an organisational culture that promotes transparency, accountability, and a commitment to continual improvement.	Policies and procedures appropriate to organisation and relevant quality standards are implemented and reviewed.
Undertake Risk Assessment and / or Business Planning for any new or expanded businesses or enterprises, or significant changes to operation.	- Risk Assessments undertaken for new businesses / enterprises, or changes to operations - New and / or expanded businesses are established in accordance with approved business plans.

Strategic Priority 2:

To support the development of a skilled, competent and local Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander workforce.

Goals	Outcomes
Develop and implement a human resources strategy that enhances and supports • Employee wellbeing • Monitoring and Reporting • Recruitment • Training Needs • Staff communication and engagement	• Human Resource Strategy implemented, resulting in: • Clear processes to support staff wellbeing processes, including process for addressing health, safety, harassment and bullying • Software and systems implemented to support human resources and KPI reporting • Transparent recruitment processes • Training needs assessment undertaken to understand workforce skills requirements • Development and implementation of a staff communication and engagement strategy that improves staff knowledge of what is happening, and capitalises on the role of staff as community advocates • Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander students reach their full potential through further education pathways • Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander youth are engaged in employment or education • Strong economic participation and development of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people and communities
Implement a management program that enhances the management capacity of our local, Palm Island workforce	Management program implemented that: • Supports succession planning into middle and senior management positions • Fosters better communication from managers to the community • Identifies and develops T-shaped people (ie generalists, capable in a range of areas) • Supports more management living on Palm Island and /or accessible to staff on Palm Island

Strategic Priority 3:

To deliver a holistic model of primary health that incorporates body, mind, spirit, land, environment, custom and socio-economic status.

Goals	Outcomes
Implement an AICCHO model of care on Palm Island, in line with the Palm Island Health Action Plan	Comprehensive, community-driven model of primary health care provided on Palm Island
Deliver a comprehensive suite of health services, from preventative health to the assessment and management of chronic disease	Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people on Palm Island enjoy long and healthy lives.
Deliver a model of maternal and child health services that meets community needs	Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander children on Palm Island are born healthy and strong.
Work with PICC community services to deliver social and emotional wellbeing services that meet the needs of Palm Island	Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people enjoy high levels of social and emotional wellbeing





Strategic Priority 4:

To deliver community services that support the physical, social, emotional, spiritual and cultural wellbeing of the people of Palm Island.

Goals	Outcomes
Undertake ongoing evaluation of service models to ensure any gaps are identified and addressed, and services work collaboratively to provide holistic, comprehensive responses to the needs of people of Palm Island	All Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people on Palm Island have access to fully comprehensive, intergenerational, whole-of-life services that meet their health and wellbeing needs
Provide a holistic, integrated model of early childhood service on Palm Island that supports engagement with early childhood education, including PICC and external services	Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander children are engaged in high quality, culturally appropriate early childhood education in their early years
Support integrated and collaborative activity between early childhood and primary health services to ensure children are meeting developmental milestones	Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander children on Palm Island thrive in their early years.
Provide therapeutic, family and domestic violence services that address the needs of the whole family	Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander families and households are safe.
Provide holistic, integrated, family focused models of service that reduce the rate of family breakdown and the removal of children	Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander children are not overrepresented in the child protection system
Provide services that reduce the incidence and harmful effects of alcohol and other drug use	Reduction in the harmful impacts of alcohol and other drug use on Palm Island
Provide adult and youth services that support people through the criminal justice system	- Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people are not overrepresented in the criminal justice system - Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander young people are not overrepresented in the criminal justice system

Strategic Priority 5:

To deliver social enterprises that promote economic development and employment opportunities for the people of Palm Island.

Goals	Outcomes
Provide services that enhance the community wealth of Palm Island, including new business opportunities	• Important unfunded services are provided on Palm Island and PICC is embedded within the Palm Island community. • Increased prosperity & social and community living
Create employment and apprenticeship / traineeship opportunities in the social enterprises sector	• Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander students reach their full potential through further education pathways • Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander youth are engaged in employment or education • Strong economic participation and development of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people and communities.

Strategic Priority 6:

To establish and maintain strong partnerships and collaborative activities to enhance health, wellbeing and economic outcomes for the people of Palm Island.

Goals	Outcomes
Identify opportunities for strategic partnerships that support the strategic priorities of PICC	PICC has documented partnerships that progress the strategic priorities of PICC, and the health, wellbeing, and economic prosperity of Palm Island
Develop and maintain key partnerships to ensure that PICC provides comprehensive, integrated health and community service responses	PICC maintains partnerships and engages in collaborative activities that support comprehensive service delivery
Develop relationships that support PICC's social enterprises	PICC maintains business and supplier relationships that result in financially viable business models in its social enterprises
Actively engage with QAIHC and other Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Health Organisations (AICCHOS) to share knowledge and resources, and benefit from collaboration	PICC becomes a full member of QAIHC and participates in collaborative activities and forums that support its primary health services
Actively engaged with QATSIPP and other community controlled child and family services to share knowledge and resources, and benefit from collaboration	PICC continues to be an active member of QATSICPP, and participates in collaborative activities and forums that support its family services



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